and 273 men were injured. The main casualties were suffered by the SFF and 1 Para commandos. The Guards also suffered heavy casualties, with twenty dead and sixty injured.

The white paper said a total of 516 civilians/terrorists were killed and 592 apprehended. Brahma Chellaney, in his story based on information obtained from postmortem reports and other sources, said that 'several' inside the temple had been shot at close range with their hands tied behind their backs and that around 1,200 had died, around double the official figure. The story was picked up by the *London Times* on 14 June 1984.

As a result, Chellaney was charged with fanning sectarian hatred, and later with sedition. Though interrogated by the police for thirty-five hours, he escaped arrest because of the Supreme Court's intervention. His passport was impounded and his press credentials not renewed. It was due to international pressure including a scathing editorial in the *New York Times* in October 1984 that the charges against him were dropped in September 1985 and his passport restored and credentials renewed.

As per estimates gleaned from intelligence and Sikh religious sources by the BBC's Satish Jacob, '... no less than 2,000 people were killed including 300 army personnel. Another 800–900 army personnel were injured, many of them crippled for life. If the government had come out with the real figures then, it would have shown that the operation was a disaster.' [27] Due to widely conflicting claims, the exact number of civilian casualties resulting from Operation Blue Star can only be determined by a competent commission of inquiry appointed by the government.

Contrary to the assurance given by General Vaidya to the prime minister, many cases of mutiny by Sikh soldiers were reported from different places. On 6 June, 600 soldiers of the 9th Battalion of the Sikh Regiment mutinied in Sri Ganganagar in Rajasthan. While some managed to cross over to Pakistan, most were rounded up by men of the Rajputana Rifles. A large-scale mutiny took place in the Sikh Regimental Centre at Ramgarh, Bihar, where 1,461 soldiers including 1,050 new recruits, stormed the armoury, killing the commandant of the centre, Brigadier H.C. Puri, and injuring two others before they set out for Amritsar.